

the social norm and causes a disturbance on an almost daily basis. These pookas prefer gated communities in the suburbs or wealthy high-rise apartments. Of course, they usually don't last very long.

Childling: These pooka know no bounds, no limits. They are, in a sense, truly wild, almost feral. They are constantly frolicking, playing pranks and telling jokes. Their falsehoods are often flagrant and they are often completely self-absorbed. They have a difficult time taking anything seriously. On the other hand, pooka in this state often have a "best friend," someone who is the center of their universe. A childling pooka will do anything for this person, and they can sometimes ground the childling and convince him to take something seriously for a moment — but probably only a moment.

Wilder: The world is a wide and wonderful place and wilder pooka want to experience it all. They seek to understand the nature of "humanity." What is it that makes someone tick? They are notorious for playing drawn out pranks that expose a person's character flaws or weaknesses. Wilders can become reckless in their thrill seeking, sometimes pushing a little too hard or taking extreme risks. Some of them even become addicted to the rush and need to be pulled back before someone gets hurt.

Grump: Subtle forms of humor and pranking are the hallmarks of grumps. They know exactly which buttons to push, but rather than playful pranks just for the sake of whimsy, grumps often use their playful sense of humor to great effect. They play the role of the fool at court, pointing out the lord's or lady's character flaws in ways that only a pooka can get away with. They also use their playfulness to defuse tense situations, or to bring a little light to a dark situation. There is no situation so dire that a pooka can't brighten the room, at least a little.

Affinity: Nature

Revelry: Pooka absolutely adore pranks, and pulling jokes on others — especially if it takes someone self-important down a peg — is a classic way they experience revelry. Pooka might also regain Glamour by spending time in an open and wild place, relaxing and being free from care.

Unleashing: Animal sounds and bright flashing colors are the hallmarks of pooka cantrips. They also often have unintended side effects, which leave egg on the face (sometimes literally) of the target or even the pooka.

BIRCHRIGHTS

Shapechanging — All pooka have an affinity with a particular animal. This is always a natural animal, never a mythological one. This animal affects her appearance and personality, and she is able to shapeshift into the animal at will. If completely alone, a pooka can shapechange for free, but if another changeling or enchanted mortal is present the change costs one Glamour. A pooka can never shift into an animal when being observed by a mundane mortal. Shifting back from animal form is always free and can be done at any time (again, as long as the pooka is unobserved by mortal eyes).

Confidante — Even complete strangers often spill their guts to a pooka. This ability of getting people to open up and talk, even about their darkest secrets, is an innate talent common to all pooka. Each has his own way of going about it, but the end result is the same. Some put people off balance with mixed insults and compliments, others rapid fire questions so fast that the target

loses track of what is being said, and some are just so darned cute that no one can resist them.

Once, during a conversation, a pooka's player may make an opposed Perception + Empathy (or Subterfuge, player's choice) roll resisted by the target's Willpower, to get the answer to a question. The number of successes determines how many questions the pooka can have answered. The target can also spend Willpower to resist this effect; each point of Willpower cancels one of the pooka's successes.

Frailty

Untruths: Perhaps the greatest con the pooka have pulled is making everyone believe that they *never* tell the truth. Under most circumstances a pooka can speak the truth as long as its mixed with lies, half-truths, and exaggerations. The trouble comes when a pooka is asked a direct question. A pooka who is asked a direct question must answer with a falsehood. If he wishes to answer truthfully the player must make a Willpower roll (difficulty 8) and spend a point of Willpower.

Stereotypes

Ryan Darktail, a weasel pooka, chatters:

On Boggans — Lazy and reckless. And they keep all of the cake to themselves!

On Clurichaun — Drunken reprobates, every last one of them.

On Eshu — Surely the most boring traveling companion you can ask for.

On Nockers — Such caring and polite folk. If you want praise and subjective criticism, they are the ones to go to.

On Piskies — And you thought we were the pranksters? *They're* the ones never to be trusted.

On Redcaps — Not exactly the most even tempered folks. Playing pranks on them can be a lot of fun though.

On Satyrs — Never give a satyr your heart — he'll most likely eat it.

On Selkies — Their hearts belong to the sea. Just be sure to ask them about their coats.

On Arcadian Sidhe — One has to wonder why they chose to return? I'm sure nothing bad has happened in Arcadia.

On Autumn Sidhe — Being so noble and regal comes so easily for them. It must be wonderful to always be at the center of every political intrigue.

On Sluagh — They have the sense of humor of a... well... umm... a dead fish?

On Trolls — Booooring! Who needs a brick wall that can pound your enemies to dust?